

SENATE BILL 1732

By Stevens

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 15,
Chapter 2, relative to days of special observance.

WHEREAS, the rule of law is the capstone of our constitutional order and the crown jewel of the American way of life; and

WHEREAS, beginning with the ratification of the Constitution on September 17, 1787, people and nations near and far have looked to the United States as a guiding light of liberty and justice; and

WHEREAS, for centuries, the world has revered America for its devotion to the timeless principle of equal justice under the law; and

WHEREAS, as we continue the work to maintain justice in our courtrooms, order on our streets, and respect for our laws, we recognize that the forces of collectivism, whose lies and false promises were responsible for the deaths of more than 100 million souls in the 20th Century alone, have not yet been defeated and remain an imminent threat to the American way of life; and

WHEREAS, President Dwight D. Eisenhower first proclaimed May 1 as "Loyalty Day" in 1955 to counter commemorations of May Day — which was frequently celebrated by communist groups — and to serve as a beacon of hope to all those still blighted by the horrors and injustices of communism and tyranny; and

WHEREAS, as President Ronald Reagan famously remarked in his 1989 Farewell Address, our nation stands before the entire world as a "tall, proud city built on rocks stronger than oceans, wind-swept, God-blessed, and teeming with people of all kinds living in harmony and peace...."; and

WHEREAS, for 250 years, the United States has proudly carried forth a grand tradition of legal and political thought stretching back to the earliest days of Western civilization, and we wish to renew our commitment to the constitutional rule of law as our pride, our glory, and an enduring source of American greatness; and

WHEREAS, on May 1, 2025, the President of the United States issued a proclamation designating Loyalty Day and Law Day, U.S.A., 2025; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that Tennessee, which entered the Federal Union on June 1, 1796, as the 16th State of the United States, join the United States of America and those states that observe May 1 of every year as "Law Day"; now, therefore,

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 15, Chapter 2, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

May 1 of each year is observed as "Law Day," to honor the rule of law as the bedrock of our political system.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.